

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 7

CONNECTICUT
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Connecticut's family courts and child-welfare system.

72

CONNECTICUT FAMILIES ON RECORD · 129 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
NOVEMBER 8, 2026

COUNTY LABELS REPORTED
19 SUBMITTED

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · CONNECTICUT

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Connecticut. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Ronald Kowalski

JUDGE · STAMFORD · **9 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She's the head judge in stamford. Has ignored multiple motions of mine asking for judge recusal, void of Judges orders, a mistrial, and a judgment for payment. I demanded I'd be removed from that Courthouse based on him and two other judges. They actually did it because I stood up and called him out. Like every case it's dystopian and insane. I know through other parties that he totally abused his ex-wife in their divorce. And this guy is overseeing and making rulings on the lives of women and children?"*

> *"Rescheduled my ex parte hearing causing an additional 2 weeks delay - from another judge's calendar to his - at the request of Alicia Chalumeau. Ignored all of my evidence proving my child was facing emotional harm and neglect. Denied my ex parte with no basis. Habitually ignores or denies all of my motions and requests."*

> *"Heavy pro father's rights...holds ex parte communications with GALs and will ignore bias Denied a motion about imminent harm to my child because the heading wasn't formatted correctly with no concern to the damage being done to the child"* STAMFORD FAMILY COURT

> *"Same has previously listed "Ronald Kowalski" Played favorites and hated even hearing from pro se- allowed violations of court orders for years with no concern for the children"* STAMFORD FAMILY COURT

> *"Same judge as Ronald kowalksi Denied motions continuously with no explanation and denied my right to even speak at hearings leading to bankruptcy for myself and my children"* STAMFORD FAMILY COURT

> *"Denied a motion about imminent harm to my child because the heading wasn't formatted correctly with no concern to the damage being done to the child"*

> *"Made sua sponte orders with no hearing, makes key decisions in chambers with attorneys that went strongly against my wishes."*

> *"Denied multiple motions without any hearings or cause."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ct-ronald-kowalski/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Heidi Opinsky

ATTORNEY (MINE) · FAIRFIELD COUNTY · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Blatantly violated attorney/client privilege to provide the other counsel with private information going against her own client"*

> *"Played favorites with GALs and attorneys in opposition of her client or the children to gain connections"*

> *"Forced me into settlement arrangements to better her career with threats"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ct-heidi-opinsky/complaint-packet
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Ingemar Heredia

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · FAIRFIELD ATTORNEY · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Contacted numerous people in my life and the public to spread lies slandering my character Encouraged his client to withhold ordered support of his child while charging and receiving 6 digits in legal fees. Recently fired from The Prince Law Firm for unethical conduct Ethics nonexistent- heavy DARVO litigator"*

> *"Never communicates....emails and calls would go unanswered Withheld child support sent through his office if I wasn't up to date with legal fees Mischaracterized and misled the court and intentionally caused continuation after continuation for his own financial benefit while my children and I had nothing."*

> *"Gave his client complete false hope costing my family (and children!) their home to support his legal fees and unethical practices."*

> *"Kept child support payments that go through him if his legal fees aren't up to date"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ct-ingemar-heredia/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Thomas O'Neill

JUDGE · STAMFORD FAMILY COURT · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Schoonmaker, George, Blomberg, Bryniczka & Welsh P.C., counsel of record for the Plaintiff in Rosenwald v. Rosenwald, FST-FA26-6078292-S, comprises numerous attorneys with deep, longstanding, and ongoing institutional, bar-leadership, and CLE-platform ties to the very Connecticut Superior Court bench from which the Honorable Thomas Joseph O'Neill — who, as a former Day Pitney LLP partner in the firm's Stamford commercial-litigation practice, has never disclosed under Canon 2.11(B) whether Day Pitney represented any of the Rosenwald-affiliated financial entities or trusts at issue in this dissolution — issued, without articulated reasoning, a one-line April 29, 2026 denial of the pro se Defendant's Practice Book § 13-5 motion specifically invoking the Fifth Amendment privilege against self-incrimination in light of eighty-five pending § 53a-223 criminal counts, twenty days before the Honorable Ronald E. Kowalski II then placed that same Defendant under oath at the outset of court-initiated sanctions inquiry on overlapping factual subject matter — and in a docket where multiple FST Family Judges have, per the on-record acknowledgment of the Honorable Jennifer DeCastro-Tunnard on May"*

> *"Now notorious as the judge removed from the Ambrose case where he ignored every psychological expert who said the children were abused Stated a proven domestic violence victim of being "the problem""*

> *"Allowed for full financial bankruptcy of a stay at home mom by allowing for delays and harassment to occur"*

> *"Refused to hear imminent harm motions for months until the damage was already done"*

> *"Made judicial decisions in complete opposition of child/psychology experts"*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Marissa Bigelli

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · FAIRFIELD · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Zero concern for the best interests of children. Completely money driven therefore markets herself to the pro fathers rights movement in the state and county. this is the same gal/pro fathers rights attorney as Marissa Bigelli- divorced from Hernandez and now using Bigelli Pro father's rights attorney and GAL- highly unethical behaviors and communications. Personal bias relationship with numerous other pro father's rights judges and attorneys"*

> *"Same as Marissa Hernandez- made custody recommendations in complete opposition of numerous child experts in favor of the parent paying her Provided information to the other side that was privileged and made custody recommendations contrary to numerous child experts"*

> *"Used threats against my child to get the outcome the party paying her wanted Used threats of loss of visitation or custody to have compliance with her requests"*

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Donna Heller

JUDGE · STAMFORD · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She handed down defective orders stripping me of custody, granted my ex sole legal and primary physical. He has lengthy criminal history, substance abuse and mental health history. I don't have any of these issues... Heller completely ignored best interests statutes, made procedural errors, abused her discretion. Her order essentially alienated me from my son with no contact for 30 days then limited visitation. No findings of abuse or neglect against me. My son has been depressed and disregulated, and lost weight since the transfer from my home in CT to his father in NY 70 miles away. She made false claims in her Memorandum of Decision."*

> *"Has been a part of our case in and out for years never making decisions, allowing exes attorney to threaten me and present clearly fraudulent financial documents and withhold hundreds of other production and Discovery material. I've also seen production of orders that completely destroy mother's from this judge and use blatantly false facts and information to back these insane orders. She is the same judge in Jennifer Dulos case that resulted in her murder 2019"*

> *"Biases toward opposing counsel"* FAIRFIELD

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ct-donna-heller/complaint-packet
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Heidi Winslow

JUDGE · DANBURY CT · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Delayed reunification, taking in to account ex-parte statements and used off the record statements made by defense council and GAL, as facts without myself present, nor any sworn testimony from myself/petitioner. (She is now retired)"*

> *"ignored my son and my rights. She is now retired. I filed the appropriate paperwork for a complaint in a timely manner, yet they denied my request. I filed a FOIA request that they ignored, and now I go to FOIC for a hearing."* DANBURY

> *"She gave the father full custody and the right to decide my visitation after saying it was a tragedy that the children allegedly did not want to see me. I appealed and won, but nothing changed. The delays were intentional."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ct-heidi-winslow/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Jennifer J. DeCastro Tunnard

JUDGE · STAMFORD · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"After already 10 years, this judge came in New. It was my contempt hearing for ongoing non-payment of child support and alimony. No new exhibits no new information and literally dismantled a six-figure judgment and Order stating that my ex must not have any money and doesn't need to pay except for small monthly payments over the course of many many years in the future. The most insane ruling ever had in all these years. I have filed numerous motions because her order was void at Livio pending appellate decision which completely Vindicated and verified my position yet no judge has ruled that I get this money and it's been over 2 years. It's the goddamn Wild Wild West. And I was told by Insiders she never should have been appointed. Our governor appoints all the judges. Insane and no accountability as always."*

> *"Made sua sponte orders on custody with no hearing or evidence. Made me pay legal fees of ex despite zero income and immense debt and no wrongdoing on my part."*

> *"Honestly, too much to write about her, but she wears her bias on her sleeve and makes unfounded sua sponte decisions"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ct-jennifer-j-decastro-tunnard/complaint-packet
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Robert Nastri, Jr.

JUDGE · HARTFORD · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Suppressed evidence at trial, issued an ambiguous court order that incites on-going conflict."* NEW HAVEN

> *"He allowed supervised visits during the police investigation."*

> *"Mostly kept us in the hallway during hearings."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ct-robert-nastri-jr/complaint-packet
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Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

CONNECTICUT AT A GLANCE.

Across 72 Connecticut families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
129
70 of 72 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$211,500
median across 39 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
24
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
66.7%
48 of 72 who answered; 43 of 72 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTY LABELS REPORTED
72	1.8	70 of 72	19

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Connecticut families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF CONNECTICUT FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	47	$40,000	$271,570	$12,763,801
Lost Wages	37	$50,000	$170,638	$6,313,600
Other Court Fees	26	$5,000	$12,493	$324,820
Therapy / Evaluations	34	$5,000	$22,433	$762,709
Reunification Services	13	$1,000	$4,163	$54,120
GAL Fees	30	$11,000	$25,417	$762,500
Asset Loss [1]	26	$150,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (39 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$211,500	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($150,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · CONNECTICUT

Most families documenting in Connecticut are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	42	60%
Active case: progress being made	6	9%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	6	9%
Case closed: within last 2 years	6	9%
Not in court but still affected	5	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only	40	56%
Both Family Court and CPS	22	31%
CPS Only	6	8%
Unknown	3	4%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

5 – 10 years	22	31%
1 – 3 years	18	26%
Over 10 years	12	17%
3 – 5 years	9	13%
6 months – 1 year	5	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

50/50 Joint	22	31%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	18	25%
Visitation Only	15	21%
Full Custody	11	15%
Children in Foster Care	5	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Fairfield	21	33%
New Haven	13	20%
Hartford	7	11%
Windham	3	5%
Waterbury	3	5%
Danbury	2	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

High Conflict Divorce	21	29%
Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	19	26%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	17	24%
Other	7	10%
Environmental/Poverty-Related (Lack of housing, utilities, etc.)	3	4%

05 PARENT VOICES — CONNECTICUT

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Connecticut comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *It has stolen mine and my children's life and given complete power to our abuser*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

I want to publicly share part of what happened during my family court case because many parents experience similar situations and stay silent out of fear. During my custody hearing, I was repeatedly prevented from responding in the same way the opposing party was allowed to. [...]

— CONNECTICUT PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM CONNECTICUT

The judges in family court abuse judicial immunity to make decisions “at their own discretion” against the advice of experts and even legal statutes. If you aren’t the one they “like” they simply destroy your life and your children’s.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cpstd. No trust in the legal system. Which is extremely scary. Don't trust the legislators

— HEIDI

I’m destroyed. My children are self harming and/or think the world is better without them.

— JESSICA

Gave abuse my children after I was the original plaintiff requested relwif from abuse

— LEI

The system never protected my children even when the GAL filed motions with the court. 6 years of financial abuse and got away with it all. The system needs a complete rework and consider coercive control a real issue.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed everything I and my kids believed in. We trust no one now.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Caused severe disabilities to me & children otherwise would be absent, halted my education in my masters degree & work as a nurse and both of my children's developmental health. Took away our autonomy , piled on further violence and traumatized any trust in systems that [...]*
>
> — MELISSA

Traumatized what should have been a perfectly normal childhood and motherhood by giving voice to the abuser to profit an entire system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Family Court has systematically and constructively alienated me from my children's lives. I contend that the court has prioritized financial profiteering for court-appointed actors and the custodial parent over the best interests of the children and my fundamental parental [...]

— SHANE

They have separated us with no end in near sight. They stop my children due to a scorned woman who used lies and deceit to her favor.

— STEVEN

Case was opened because of my husband's abusive disciplinary actions. This led to older son becoming aggressive toward his sister. Yet he 13 and sister is 10. My children were removed because they said I put my children in harms way. My youngest daughter was given to the same [...]

— DANIELLA

Five years in court has stolen precious time that my daughter and I will never get back. Instead of finding protection and justice, we found a system that left us feeling powerless while enabling continued abuse. The greatest cost has not been financial, but the childhood my [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Erica Tindell Leally break mothers, Steal our children, Supports Dad's

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *I was so naive but became so aware of how uncaring professionals in a court system and those supposed to be acting in the children's best interests were and that there were actually people in positions of authority who abuse their positions of power and act as the devil's [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tarnished my favorable opinion of the court/justice system. My distrust is immeasurable and my belief of absolute corruption is steadfast. Both kids had to deal with the stress of alienation and displaced family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed our lives and traumatized my son. Taken our freedom. My son and I deserve to be together. Taken from his present education, future education and college planning.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They covered all the facts made me lose addiction in Connecticut and they took my son from Connecticut to Kentucky.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed my health, my child's development and mental health, and violated constitutional and human rights with no concern for the damage they have done.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have taken my daughter childhood and my happiness and life from me only because I fought against abuse, this demonic system must end. Now!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed everything. I have lost my place of residence. My means of transportation due to a narcissistic ex-wife I pay substantial amount of child support which is $360 a week. In the past 5 years I have maybe seen my children a dozen times. I have not seen them in 2 [...]

— DERRICK

My family has been robbed, deprived, and destroyed by DCF.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system cost my children a mother, grandmother, cousins, and a future surrounded by people who loved them. Instead, they were left with anger, division, and loss.

— CHRISTINE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Fucking destroyed us*
>
> — CATHERINE

I was duped by a fake advocate who basically stole my money.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The effect of this is had on my family I hope someday will get better

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court had caused a significant amount of Emotional and financial stress by placing a child back in the hands of a known abuser . And time away from her siblings.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This agonizing separation has deeply fractured my family, leaving me to endure years of heartbreaking alienation from my son, while navigating a devastating emotional and financial toll. This systemic battle against the courts has exhausted and traumatized me while [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed father, mother child relationship to the point that our family is destroyed. Father tried to commit suicide and left both parents with no money left; harmed child irreversibly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Family Court allowed all my assets to be lost without any concern to the financial and emotional damage done to myself and my child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court allowed fraudulent “experts” and then ignored the recommendations of legitimate experts hiding behind the shield of judicial immunity and playing a congeniality game with people’s lives.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The custody proceedings and transfer devastated both me and my autistic son, causing severe emotional trauma, fear, and instability as he began crying, begging to return home, and expressing fear and resentment toward his father. The prolonged litigation also financially [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *It has suppressed a mom trying to implement faith and morals and sided with actions of corruption and views of other because it was more mainstream. Faith and conservative morals was not favored but rather bias favoritism.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Iverson was wrongly taken by his father, who has schizoaffective bipolar disorder and demonstrated ongoing delusions, yet despite six months of filings in two courts with documented proof, my concerns were repeatedly ignored. Instead of hearing or reviewing the evidence, the [...]

— SAMANTHA VALDEZ

The system is complicit in domestic violence..they literally participate in post separation abuse by claiming intelligent ignorance about domestic violence and refuse to hear evidence labeling these as high conflict and allowing the litigious abuse to continue

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system took me away from my four-year-old son on his birthday and my one-year-old-infant based on allegations the court itself later rejected. One hundred and twenty-eight days later, my boys remain without their father — not because of any finding of harm, but because in a [...]

— ABE

This prolonged family court battle has devastated our lives—driving me into over $100,000 of legal debt, severely damaging my mental health and private practice, and forcing me to live in constant fear that despite extensive evidence, the system may still place my son alone with [...]

— EMMA

I became chronically ill and could not work for almost a decade after the case was closed my ex went on a rampage and completed the final blow of getting my son to hate us. The eyes of the court were off of him and he succeeded. On a visitation my then 15 year old sexually [...]

— JENNIFER

Being coerced into cooperating with child services a decade ago taught me that speaking out about abuse only leads to endless court battles where money matters more than the truth. Over the past ten years, this nightmare has cost me my peace and millions in assets, leaving me [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

44 Connecticut parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — CONNECTICUT

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Connecticut families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> It has stolen mine and my children's life and given complete power to our abuser
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The judges in family court abuse judicial immunity to make decisions “at their own discretion” against the advice of experts and even legal statutes. If you aren’t the one they “like” they simply destroy your life and your children’s.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I want to publicly share part of what happened during my family court case because many parents experience similar situations and stay silent out of fear. During my custody hearing, I was repeatedly prevented from responding in the same way the opposing party was allowed to. When I attempted to repeat statements made by the other party in order to respond to accusations, I was stopped and told it was “hearsay.” Meanwhile, similar statements from the opposing side were allowed without the same restriction. At one point, while trying to explain my actions and defend myself against accusations, the judge stated, “you have an answer for everything.” Comments like this made it clear that my explanations were being treated as a problem rather than part of my legal defense. Serious accusations were discussed in court without supporting evidence or verification. Allegations related to alcohol use and physical punishment were given attention despite there being no history of alcohol abuse, no criminal history, no medical concerns, and no substantiated abuse findings. Prior investigations involving my home resulted in no findings of abuse or neglect. At the same time, documentation I presented — including prior restraining orders, evidence of harassment, and communications showing attempts to influence therapists and other professionals involved with the children — was not given meaningful consideration. The court also focused heavily on the fact that my adult sons do not have a relationship with their father, implying that I was responsible for it. However, both of my sons are adults over 18 and capable of making their own decisions and forming their own opinions. Despite this
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/3)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

issue being central to the hearing, their testimony was not heard. I was also criticized for following the custody agreement exactly as written. The agreement stated that the father could only pick the children up from school with my permission, so I provided the school with a copy of the agreement and informed them of the terms. During the hearing, this was described as “absurd,” despite the fact that I was following a court-approved agreement signed by both parties. False statements were also made in court about my husband, including claims that the school listed him as the children’s father. This was untrue and could easily have been verified through school records and birth certificates, but I was not given a meaningful opportunity to address these statements through testimony. The temporary orders that followed removed all of my weekend parenting time. As a result, the only time I can see my children is during weekdays when they are in school and I am working. The court also suspended child support despite me remaining the primary day-to-day caregiver and despite the significant income difference between the parents. This created severe financial hardship while still expecting me to maintain the children’s stability and daily needs. The court additionally ordered that I should not discuss court matters with my adult sons, even though they are adults and not parties to the custody case. This created confusion about how ordinary communication between adults within the same household could be restricted. What happened in my case raised serious concerns about unequal treatment, unsupported accusations being treated as fact, and evidence not being evaluated equally.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/3)

Family courts have enormous power over parents and children. That power should be exercised through evidence, fairness, equal standards, and proper procedure — not assumptions, intimidation, or unequal application of the rules.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (3/3)

Cpstd. No trust in the legal system. Which is extremely scary. Don't trust the legislators

— HEIDI

I’m destroyed. My children are self harming and/or think the world is better without them.

— JESSICA

Gave abuse my children after I was the original plaintiff requested relwif from abuse

— LEI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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— MELISSA

Traumatized what should have been a perfectly normal childhood and motherhood by giving voice to the abuser to profit an entire system.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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They covered all the facts made me lose addiction in Connecticut and they took my son from Connecticut to Kentucky.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed my health, my child's development and mental health, and violated constitutional and human rights with no concern for the damage they have done.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have taken my daughter childhood and my happiness and life from me only because I fought against abuse, this demonic system must end. Now!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed everything. I have lost my place of residence. My means of transportation due to a narcissistic ex-wife I pay substantial amount of child support which is $360 a week. In the past 5 years I have maybe seen my children a dozen times. I have not seen them in 2 years. This has to stop

— DERRICK

My family has been robbed, deprived, and destroyed by DCF.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system cost my children a mother, grandmother, cousins, and a future surrounded by people who loved them. Instead, they were left with anger, division, and loss.

— CHRISTINE

Fucking destroyed us

— CATHERINE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I was duped by a fake advocate who basically stole my money.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The effect of this is had on my family I hope someday will get better

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court had caused a significant amount of Emotional and financial stress by placing a child back in the hands of a known abuser . And time away from her siblings.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This agonizing separation has deeply fractured my family, leaving me to endure years of heartbreaking alienation from my son, while navigating a devastating emotional and financial toll. This systemic battle against the courts has exhausted and traumatized me while simultaneously needing to muster strength to fight to protect my son from the founded abuse and to have a safe return home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed father, mother child relationship to the point that our family is destroyed. Father tried to commit suicide and left both parents with no money left; harmed child irreversibly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Family Court allowed all my assets to be lost without any concern to the financial and emotional damage done to myself and my child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court allowed fraudulent “experts” and then ignored the recommendations of legitimate experts hiding behind the shield of judicial immunity and playing a congeniality game with people’s lives.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The custody proceedings and transfer devastated both me and my autistic son, causing severe emotional trauma, fear, and instability as he began crying, begging to return home, and expressing fear and resentment toward his father. The prolonged litigation also financially destroyed me, ultimately resulting in foreclosure proceedings against my home after years of living under threats that my son would be taken away from me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has suppressed a mom trying to implement faith and morals and sided with actions of corruption and views of other because it was more mainstream. Faith and conservative morals was not favored but rather bias favoritism.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Iverson was wrongly taken by his father, who has schizoaffective bipolar disorder and demonstrated ongoing delusions, yet despite six months of filings in two courts with documented proof, my concerns were repeatedly ignored. Instead of hearing or reviewing the evidence, the court escalated matters by placing my son into CPS care without fully considering the facts I presented.

— SAMANTHA VALDEZ

The system is complicit in domestic violence..they literally participate in post separation abuse by claiming intelligent ignorance about domestic violence and refuse to hear evidence labeling these as high conflict and allowing the litigious abuse to continue

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system took me away from my four-year-old son on his birthday and my one-year-old-infant based on allegations the court itself later rejected. One hundred and twenty-eight days later, my boys remain without their father — not because of any finding of harm, but because in a high-net-worth divorce the legal process itself, asymmetrically applied, became the instrument of our separation.

— ABE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This prolonged family court battle has devastated our lives—driving me into over $100,000 of legal debt, severely damaging my mental health and private practice, and forcing me to live in constant fear that despite extensive evidence, the system may still place my son alone with a parent who has already endangered his physical and emotional safety. It has robbed my son of the carefree childhood he once had and robbed me of the ability to be fully present as his mother, as we both now live under the weight of anxiety, manipulation, and the ongoing threat that the system meant to protect him could fail him.

— EMMA

I became chronically ill and could not work for almost a decade after the case was closed my ex went on a rampage and completed the final blow of getting my son to hate us. The eyes of the court were off of him and he succeeded. On a visitation my then 15 year old sexually assaulted his half brother my son who had just turned 5 at the time. During the assault he told his little brother he hates him he hates me and is also going to assault me as well, he told my then 5 year old he would kill him if he told anyone. The police are involved and when interviewed by police my ex told them I made it all up to get them back for winning sole custody. We are waiting for my son to heal enough to complete the forensic interview as he was so young nervous and could not articulate to the interviewer. After police contacted my ex and son they cut contact with me and I have not seen or spoken to him since August 17 2023. We still have a parenting time with orders for communication but I have been so traumatized by this experience and am in therapy to build the endurance for when my now 7 year old talks to police and the DA gets involved.

— JENNIFER

Being coerced into cooperating with child services a decade ago taught me that speaking out about abuse only leads to endless court battles where money matters more than the truth. Over the past ten years, this nightmare has cost me my peace and millions in assets, leaving me with nothing but debt and sleepless nights.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Financially devastated and bankrupt me and our three kids. Financially, emotionally, and psychologically. While he has amassed millions in properties and cars Etc. This was about torturing me and making me pay using our three kids. I've said going to court has been his drug of choice. With no end in sight but I refuse to go back to Family Court. I will never stop. People like all of us, and my Rock the Walls this year will be different and we will be so loud they can't ignore any of us anymore. I'M DONE!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My daughter has completely let me go at 12 years old. All allegations were proven wrong. Case is closed and I'm still not seeing my child. People who represent allegations should be certain with proof that they are true before ripping someone's child away, for a maybe situation. My child is broken. Our relationship has suffered, but the absence doesn't remove the love I have to see it through.

— RACHEL

My son no longer speaks with my side of the family. The court set things up so my communication with our son was so limited. Then she selects a therapist who doesn't use me for onboarding our son, refused to speak with me the first 3 months of therapy, includes my ex in therapy and never me, then terminates care, blaming me for his issues. My ex was given what she originally intended with a complicit court, to erase my son's father and his family from his life.

— KEVIN

The family court system does not truly care about what is in the best interest of the child, despite constantly claiming that it does. Instead, I watched prolonged litigation, power imbalances, and financial incentives take priority over preserving the parent-child relationship. You are welcome to reach out to me if you have any follow up questions. I can also give you my real name. I have to be careful like many of us out there.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

44 full approved Connecticut comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Connecticut report comes from Connecticut respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Connecticut — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 72 Connecticut families reporting here are not the universe of Connecticut families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – November 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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